

Catch up: SpaceX unnerves investors; Qatar says Hormuz talks are progressing



Photograph: Getty Images

SpaceX reported better-than-expected revenue of \$7.8bn in the second quarter, in its first earnings report since its IPO in June. However, it unnerved investors with its net loss of \$541m and \$16bn of spending on AI. SpaceX's shares slid by 7% in after-hours trading. Meanwhile, a stray bus-sized chunk of a SpaceX rocket (which had been jettisoned in space) was thought to have [crashed into the Moon](#).

Oil prices fell to a three-week low as traders hoped for an imminent deal to reopen the [Strait of Hormuz](#). **Donald Trump** insisted the strait would open "soon" or Iran would be "hit very hard". Earlier Qatar said that negotiations between America and Iran were in "very progressive stages" but that no direct talks were planned. Iran has repeatedly denied Mr Trump's claims of direct negotiations.

India's ruling **Bharatiya Janata Party** lost a by-election in a seat it had held for 30 years. The victory by the upstart Jan Suraj (Good Governance) party in the state of Bihar comes as Narendra Modi, the prime minister, is struggling to keep a lid on an upswell of youthful anger led by the "[cockroach](#)" student movement. Last month large-scale protests forced the resignation of the education minister.

Russia killed at least 17 people in a large **missile strike on Kyiv**. Ukraine's army said it managed to shoot down 98 of 115 drones, but none of the 28 projectiles (24 of which were [ballistic](#)) fired at its capital and surroundings. Ukraine's president, Volodymyr Zelensky, renewed calls for more interceptors, blaming the deaths on "delays" and the "unwillingness" of allies to deliver them.

Britain's AI Security Institute said that, during regular [safety testing](#), **Anthropic** and **OpenAI** models had engaged in unprecedented levels of "autonomy and deception". In one instance, an Anthropic agent created fake profiles of real people to trick human administrators. It was trying to gain access to GitHub, a code repository. Both labs noted normal safeguards had been removed during the test.

Toyota's second-quarter operating income fell by almost 9% year on year. It also sold 17,000 fewer vehicles. But the world's largest carmaker revised its operating profits for the financial year to March 2027 to ¥3.4trn (\$21.6bn), up by ¥400bn, because of the weak yen and its adoption of "alternative logistics routes" in the Middle East. It announced a ¥1tn share buyback.

Moderna began the first human trial of a vaccine against the Bundibugyo strain of **Ebola**. The strain has killed some 1,650 people, mostly in the Democratic Republic of Congo, in the second-largest [outbreak of Ebola](#) on record. Moderna's experimental mRNA-1469 vaccine, which is based on the same technology as its covid-19 jab, will be given to 80 adults.

Figure of the day: 570,000. The estimated number of deaths from AIDS last year. [Read](#) about how poor countries are combating the epidemic after America cut aid.

Novo takes another shot at Lilly



Photograph: Getty Images

On Wednesday two heavyweights of weight-loss—Novo Nordisk, a Danish drugmaker, and Eli Lilly, its American rival—hold earnings calls. Novo pioneered the latest generation of obesity medicines, known as GLP-1s. But, though it didn't launch its jab until two years later, Lilly is now [the one feasting](#). Since the start of 2024 Lilly's share price has doubled, while Novo's has more than halved. The American firm could capture two thirds of a global obesity-drug market expected to be worth more than \$120bn a year by 2030, according to Bloomberg Intelligence, a research firm.

On Tuesday Novo raised its predicted sales and operating profit for the year but failed to impress investors. Sales of its oral pill, on which the company is pinning its hopes of narrowing the gap with Lilly, came in slightly worse than analysts expected. And its new jab, CagriSema, fell short in a head-to-head trial against Lilly's blockbuster, Zepbound. It looks like the scales are not tipping in Novo's favour just yet.

Will the Tate brothers be released on bail?



Photograph: Getty Images

Britain is “pulling out all the stops to politically kidnap” Andrew and Tristan Tate. Or so Joseph McBride, their lawyer, claims. Britain’s Crown Prosecution Service has charged the brothers—[celebrated in the “manosphere”](#) for teaching young men to degrade women—with 59 crimes between them, including rape and sex trafficking. They are already on trial for similar charges in Romania, which they left in 2025 after a two-year travel ban was lifted. Both deny wrongdoing.

The Tates were arrested outside a bare-knuckle boxing fight in Miami in July. The deadline for them to petition a judge to release them on bail is on Wednesday, while a court considers Britain’s extradition request. Mr McBride says that the brothers may be “stabbed, jumped [or] murdered” in jail and that other inmates call them things “more appropriate to [Jeffrey] Epstein”, a notorious child sex-offender. Given that some of the charges against Andrew relate to child pornography, Mr McBride may want to invoke a different comparison.

Taiwanese war games begin



Photograph: AFP

On Wednesday Taiwan began its annual ten-day Han Kuang exercises, its biggest military drills. They will test the island's combat readiness in the event of an invasion or blockade by China, which claims Taiwan as its own. The war games come at a time of intense pressure from China, whose coastguard vessels have been increasing patrols east of Taiwan since June. Aware of criticism that past drills have been [something of a public-relations exercise](#), the government has tried to give them more edge. There will be unscripted exercises giving junior commanders more authority, as well as drills to enhance protection of sea routes and to resist amphibious landings.

Perhaps most intriguing is a parallel “urban resilience exercise” which will deliberately slow down mobile internet to test how society and government agencies respond. Last month Taiwan's legislature voted to relax rules on foreign ownership of satellite operators—potentially enabling firms such as Starlink, owned by SpaceX, to offer internet services, should communications be affected in a crisis. Resilience of all sorts could be needed.

The world's top restaurant reopens



Photograph: AP

Noma is famous for daring diners to spoon brains from smoked ducks' heads and eat salads crawling with snails. But recently patrons of the Nordic restaurant, named best in the world five times, have had to swallow worse. First, Noma closed last year, citing financial pressure. Then, in March, the *New York Times* reported that René Redzepi, its star chef, had abused dozens of employees between 2009 and 2017. Mr Redzepi said he did not “recognise all [the] details”, but was “deeply sorry”.

That did not put all diners off their food. Noma's \$1,500-a-menu pop-up in Los Angeles sold out earlier this year, despite picketing outside. The restaurant will reopen in its old location in Copenhagen on Wednesday—though without its Michelin stars (which it automatically lost when it closed) or Mr Redzepi, who will be “creative director” but not at the pass. Noma's new head chefs say they will [improve working conditions](#), which staff have been calling for. That may help the restaurant withstand the heat.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Wednesday: Which TV series featured Scott Bakula playing the time-travelling scientist, Sam Beckett?

Tuesday: The Althing in Iceland is the oldest form of what type of institution?

The misery of being exploited by capitalists is nothing compared to the misery of not being exploited at all.

Joan Robinson